

However, in real-world use, it's a different story. Playing games such as COD: Mobile and BGMI at native 144fps, and Genshin Impact at 60fps, only made it lukewarm, which shows that while the thermals shoot up during synthetic benchmarks, in real-world use, the phone keeps things under control. Moreover, performance stays consistent, and that's what actually matters.

Another thing that makes or breaks my smartphone experience is haptic feedback. On the iQOO 15R, haptics are tight and precise. There's also an ultrasonic fingerprint reader, which is rare and welcome at this price. It's fast, accurate, and just feels more premium than optical solutions.

The move from FuntouchOS to OriginOS 6 has helped. After having used and tested a bunch of OriginOS-powered phones, I am certain that the change in direction in terms of software is more than just the naming. The general experience, including smooth animations and fast app launches, has been great. Granted, there is bloatware, but most of it can be uninstalled. AI features like Circle to Search, AI summarisation, AI eraser and photo enhancement tools are present. All the essentials are covered.

BATTERY LIFE

Here's the part that genuinely impressed me. The 7,600 mAh battery. This is one of the largest on any phone around, unless you count something like the Realme P4 Power with its 10,000 mAh unit. So, packing this large battery into a relatively compact body is impressive on the part of iQOO.

In my usage, the iQOO 15R comfortably lasted two full days on moderate use. And I'm not a light user. I stream YouTube and Netflix. I use WhatsApp calls, including video. I browse, scroll Instagram, use Google services, click photos and play games. Twice during testing, I pushed it without charging and ended the second day with around 15% still left. The results in PCMark's battery test were also impressive, as the phone lasted an excellent 28 hours.



If you drive to work and use Android Auto, you may rarely see it dip below 50% on a typical weekday. For people who are always near a charger, there's no battery anxiety, and for those who are not, this phone is reassuring.

CAMERAS

The iQOO 15R uses a 50 MP Sony LYT700 primary rear camera, an 8 MP ultra-wide and a 32 MP front camera.

The main camera does a very good job. In daylight, photos are detailed with good colour balance. HDR handling is strong. Even tricky backlit shots come out well. The 2x digital crop from the main sensor is also surprisingly usable.

The ultra-wide camera is where things dip slightly. Detail levels are lower, and there is noticeable colour disparity compared to the main sensor. It's fine for occasional wide shots, but it's not class-leading.

The front camera performs well, especially in HDR-heavy scenarios. Selfies captured against the sun retain good detail. Low-light shots are decent, though not exceptional.

Honestly, when it comes to the camera system, I would have really preferred a telephoto lens instead of the ultra-wide. A dedicated telephoto camera would have completed the near-flagship feel. Again, not that

it's a deal breaker, but it feels like a missed opportunity.

One more thing I kept thinking about is the USB port. With this much performance, a USB 3.2 port instead of USB 2.0 would have been nice for external display output and faster data transfer. If you're building a performance-focused phone, small additions like that could elevate the experience further. But is it too much to ask?

VERDICT

This phone doesn't just exist for the sake of it; it feels deliberate. The iQOO 15R feels like iQOO remembering what made its earlier flagships exciting. Not just power for the sake of it, but power in a form factor you can afford and actually live with every day.

—Aman Rashid

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 8 Gen 5 Mobile Platform | RAM: 8/12 GB | Storage: 256/512 GB | Display: 6.59-inch 1.5K AMOLED | Refresh Rate: 144 Hz | Brightness: 1825 nits | Camera (Rear): 50 MP + 8 MP | Camera (Front): 32 MP | Battery: 7600 mAh | Charging: 100W

CONTACT

iQOO | Telephone: 1800 572 4700 | Email: Web Form | Website: www.iqoo.com/in

Read more on Digit.in:
tinyurl.com/iQ15r7x